

Silvia Téliz

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Summary

I am a PhD candidate (expected July 2027) at the Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania, studying how social identity is visually conveyed and leveraged in political communication. I combine computer vision, natural language processing, and machine learning to analyze large-scale text, image, and video data — from out-of-home political advertisements in Mexican elections to political expression on TikTok — and to study bias in AI systems such as vision-language models.

Education

Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania , PhD in Communication – Philadelphia, PA, USA Degree expected in July 2027.	July 2027
Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania , Master of Arts in Communication – Philadelphia, PA, USA	May 2024
Universidad Panamericana , Bachelor of Arts in Communication – Mexico City, Mexico	May 2018

Technical Skills and Methodologies

Methods: Computational visual analysis, natural language processing, machine learning, social media data collection, survey and experiment design, content analysis

Programming: Python, R, Git, HTML, CSS

Software: Gephi, Adobe Illustrator, GitHub, Stata

AI Tools and Deployment: Hugging Face Transformers, Ollama, OpenRouter, proprietary LLM APIs (Anthropic, OpenAI, Gemini), PyTorch

Languages: Spanish: native speaker, English: advanced (C2), French: intermediate (B2), German: intermediate (B1)

Relevant Experience

Research Fellow, Politics, Identities, and Communication Lab – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania May 2025 – present

- Secured \$10,000 USD via the Annenberg School for Communication Internal Grant for the project ‘Identifying Biases in VLMs’ Zero-Shot Classifications of Race and Gender’ (2026-2027 academic year), as principal investigator.
- Contributed to the theoretical conceptualization, formulation of overarching research goals, methodology design, computational analysis of text and image data, writing, reviewing, and editing for projects developed within the lab under Dr. Deen Freelon’s supervision.

Teaching Fellow, Introduction to Communication Behavior – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania Jan 2026 – May 2026

- Taught lecture ‘Media Effects on Community and Everyday Culture’.
- Taught recitation section, providing students with additional support and guidance on course materials.
- Provided individual assistance and clarification during dedicated office hours.
- Assisted the instructor with logistical tasks, such as managing the online learning platform and maintaining grade and attendance records.
- Graded and provided dedicated feedback for assignments and final papers.

Research Fellow, Center for Advanced Research in Global Communication – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania Aug 2022 – Aug 2023

- Worked under Dr. Juan Llamas Rodríguez's supervision on the development of a mixed-methods study on the representation of gender and skin color stereotypes in Mexican telenovelas and TV series (a report commissioned by the Luminate foundation).

Teaching Fellow, Children and Media – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Taught lecture 'Racial Representations in Children's Media'.
- Provided individual assistance and clarification during dedicated office hours.
- Assisted the instructor with logistical tasks, such as managing the online learning platform and maintaining grade and attendance records.
- Graded and provided dedicated feedback for assignments and final papers.
- Assisted in designing and grading exams.

Instructor of Record, Quantitative Methods for Communication Research – Universidad Panamericana, Mexico City Jan 2020 – Dec 2022

- Served as the Instructor of Record for an undergraduate-level course, delivering all lectures and directing all class activities for the Communication major.
- Introduced the programming language R into the curriculum as the main tool for learning Quantitative Methods.
- Designed all educational materials, including original slides, assignments, tests, and lab activities.
- Held regular office hours for student assistance and managed the grading of all assignments, including weekly lab activities and final projects.

Research Assistant, Facultad Latinoamericana de Ciencias Sociales (FLACSO) – Mexico City, Mexico 2018 – 2022

- Coordinated a research consulting project to identify the strengths and weaknesses of the evaluation system of information transparency for the National Institute of Access to Information and Personal Data Protection.
- Developed an academic program and created didactic content for the National School for Women of the Institutional Revolutionary Party, empowering female members through education on gender perspective, political representation, and communication strategies.
- Created educational content for the Migrant-e project (led by the Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México), teaching undocumented immigrants in the United States about their rights and safety tools.

Publications

WhichTok? Comparing Three TikTok Data Acquisition Tools 2026

Gayoung Jeon, Cameron Moy, Silvia Téliz, Cristina Monzer, Nicolette Alayon, Deen Freelon
arxiv.org/abs/2608.09917 (arXiv preprint)

Poder Prieto: Media, Colorism, and Cultural Activism in Mexico 2026

Juan Llamas-Rodríguez, Silvia Téliz Martínez
nyupress.org/9781479835164/planet-digital (Planet Digital, NYU Press)

Agresiones a periodistas y cobertura mediática de la corrupción 2021

Georgina Flores-Ivich, Silvia Téliz Martínez
[10.2307/j.ctv1jhvn9w](https://doi.org/10.2307/j.ctv1jhvn9w) (Crisis de estatalidad y violaciones a derechos humanos, FLACSO México)

Presentations

Mechanisms of Social Bias in Large Language Models: Disentangling Linguistic Framing from Group Specification July 2026

Vishwanath Emani Venkata, Silvia Téliz
 IC2S2 conference - Burlington, VT, USA - conference presentation

Picturing Immigration: A Multimodal Computational Analysis of the 2024 U.S. Presidential Campaign August 2025

Silvia Téliz, Gayoung Jeon

PolNet-PACSS conference - Boston, MA, USA - poster presentation

A Picture is Worth a Thousand Fictions: Visual Political Communication in the Age of Generative AI April 2025

Silvia Téliz

CIND Workshop 2025 - Philadelphia, PA, USA - invited talk

Hues of Victory: Using Computer Vision to Examine Skin Color's Influence on Electoral Success June 2024

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ICA Preconference: "A Computational Turn in Journalism: Opportunities and Challenges in a Cross-Disciplinary Field" - Singapore - conference presentation

Status, Color and Race: Dissecting the content of Latin American class stereotypes May 2023

Valentina Proust Iligaray, Silvia Téliz

ICA Preconference: "Media and Communication in Global Latinidades" - Online - conference presentation

Honors and Awards

Annenberg School for Communication Internal Grant 2026

\$10,000 USD, principal investigator, for the project 'Identifying Biases in VLMs' Zero-Shot Classifications of Race and Gender' (2026-2027 academic year).

Graduate Scholarship in Sciences and Humanities 2025

Awarded by the Ministry of Science, Humanities, Technology and Innovation of Mexico (SECIHTI)

Fulbright García-Robles Scholarship 2022

Awarded by the US-Mexico Foundation (COMEXUS)

Certificates

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science 2026

Awarded by the University of Pennsylvania

Certificate in College and University Teaching 2025

Awarded by the University of Pennsylvania

Scholarly Memberships and Service

Center for Information Networks and Democracy – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania 2023 – present

Doctoral fellow and meeting administrator

Center for Advanced Research in Global Communication – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania 2022 – 2025

Doctoral fellow

Graduate Student Council – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania 2023 – 2024

Member and information manager